

Ticker: SKE CN**PF net cash:** C\$116m**Project:** Eskay Creek**Market cap:** C\$605m**Price:** C\$6.66/sh**Country:** Canada, BC

REC. (unc): BUY

TARGET (+270c): C\$15.00/sh

RISK RATING (unc): HIGH

*By our math, we estimate an overall ~15% cost of capital on this week's pre-permit funding from Orion. We calculate the stream at US\$2,000/oz gold price and US\$30/oz silver, equating to 14% IRR (or ~18% at spot) assuming the stream is drawn at SCPe build start 4Q24, which is a key sensitivity worth noting i.e. the IRR increases if drawn later. Same goes for the over-run facility, where we estimate a ~23.5% IRR if drawn 6M before first production – the real 'icing on the cake' for Orion in our view, albeit we think post permitting / de-risking should warrant a positive re-financing opportunity before the over-run facility is needed. Most importantly, the funding allows Skeena to continue operational momentum through permitting towards 1H27 production target date, meaning some long lead items / pre-construction work can commence before full permits are granted, which helps maintain target dates—a key de-risking catalyst in our view. As such, we update our model for the Orion funding (incl. higher cash + share count) and lift our 0.5xNAV multiple to 0.8xNAV to reflect the lower risk given SCPe implied \$139m 'buffer' based on 1H27 first gold. As such, **we maintain our BUY rating and lift our C\$12.30/sh PT to C\$15.00/sh** based on 0.8x NAV5%-2,000 for the asset at build start plus a nominal US\$75/oz for Snip. Stepping back, Skeena is positioned to be Canada's next gold-silver mine build upon submitting the EA draft application this summer. While currently in the inevitable Lassonde curve 'valley', we think this could change quickly over the coming 12M on positive permitting catalysts, commencement of pre-construction activities, and with further gold / silver price momentum (70-30 / Au-Ag revenue).*

US\$750m Orion financing preserves schedule through permitting towards 1H27 production

Earlier this week, Skeena announced a US\$750 million project financing package with Orion Resource Partners for the development, construction, and general working capital needed to advance the Eskay Creek Gold-Silver Project towards 1H27 production. The financing package includes:

- **US\$100m Equity Investment:** with a portion priced and closing immediately, and US\$25m closing later. Orion will own less than 20% of Skeena's shares upon completion and has rights to participate in future equity offerings.
- **US\$200m Gold Stream:** drawn in five tranches (incl. initial US\$5m, US\$45m following receipt of the Technical Sample permit, and remaining three in US\$50m tranches available as needed). Orion will receive 10.55% of payable gold (for the area +500m around existing MRE/reserve limits) once fully drawn at 10% of the LBMA AM gold fixing price for the LOM. Skeena has the option to buy back 66.7% of the stream in the 12 months following the project completion date.
- **US\$350m Senior Secured Loan:** A 5.75-year term drawn over four equal US\$87.5m tranches @ 3-month SOFR+7.75%. Interest will be paid quarterly, and principal repayments will start three months post-project completion in 15 quarterly installments. Additionally, there is a 1% standby fee and no break fee.
- **US\$100m Cost Over-Run Facility:** provided at similar terms to the Senior Secured Loan, with a 2% original issue discount and a 1% availability fee.

Why we like Skeena

1. Large high-grade open pit with SCPe >500koz upside potential in coming 12-18M
2. Shift in market dynamics allows concentrate sales for lower capex
3. Optionality from high-grade Snip mine nearby to blend concentrate or add ounces
4. Catalyst heavy with drilling, metallurgy, and DFS optimizations in coming 12M

Catalysts

1. CY24: Long lead orders and civil (pre-permitting) construction start
2. 2Q24: PFS-level study on Snip based on M&I
3. Mid 2025: permits complete

4. Mid 2026: production start up

Research

Brandon Gaspar (Toronto) m +1 437 533 3142 bgaspar@scp-rf.com

Eleanor Magdzinski (Toronto) m +1 705 669 7456 emagdzinski@scp-rf.com

Ticker: SKE CN	Price / mkt cap: C\$6.66/sh, C\$605m	Project PNAV today: 0.35x	Asset: Eskay Creek / Snip
Author: B Gaspar	Rec / 0.8xNAV PT: BUY, C\$15/sh	1xNAV ₂₀₂₄ FF FD: C\$18.79/sh	Country: Canada: BC

Commodity price	CY22A	CY23A	CY24E	CY25E	CY26E
Gold price	1,807	1,950	2,288	2,154	2,011
SOTP project valuation*					
	C\$M	O/ship	NAVx	C\$/sh	

Ungeared proj. @ build start	2,429	100%	1.00x	24.34	
Pro-forma net cash 3Q24	116	100%	1.00x	1.16	
Cash from options	53	100%	1.00x	0.53	
Snip (US\$75/oz)	94	100%	1.00x	0.94	
Asset NAV5% C\$2000/oz	2,692			27.0	

*Shares diluted for options but not mine build Market P/NAV 0.25x

Share data			
Basic shares (m)	90.8	FD with build equity raise	121.1
FD with options (m)	99.8		

Asset value: 1xNPV project @ build start (C\$m, ungeared)*

Project NPV (C\$m)*	\$1800oz	\$1900oz	\$2000oz	\$2100oz	\$2200oz
10.0% discount	1,575	1,765	1,954	2,144	2,334
7.5% discount	1,826	2,045	2,265	2,485	2,704
5.0% discount	2,123	2,379	2,635	2,891	3,147
Ungeared project IRR:	47%	51%	54%	57%	60%
Project NPV (C\$/sh)*	\$1800oz	\$1900oz	\$2000oz	\$2100oz	\$2200oz
10.0% discount	15.78	17.68	19.58	21.48	23.38
7.5% discount	18.29	20.49	22.69	24.89	27.09
5.0% discount	21.27	23.83	26.4	28.96	31.53

*Project level NPV, excl finance costs and central SG&A, discounted to build start

Group valuation over time^	Sep-24	Sep-25	Sep-26	Sep-27	Sep-28
Eskay Creek (C\$m)	2,360	2,697	3,126	3,414	2,890
Net cash prior qtr (C\$m)	160	51	(290)	(92)	501
G&A and finance costs (C\$m)	(391)	(390)	(335)	(268)	(209)
Cash from options (C\$m)	53	53	53	53	53
Snip	94	94	94	94	94
NAV FF FD (C\$m)	2,275	2,505	2,648	3,201	3,328
1xNAV _{5%} /sh FF FD (C\$/sh)	18.79*	20.68*	21.86*	26.43*	27.48*

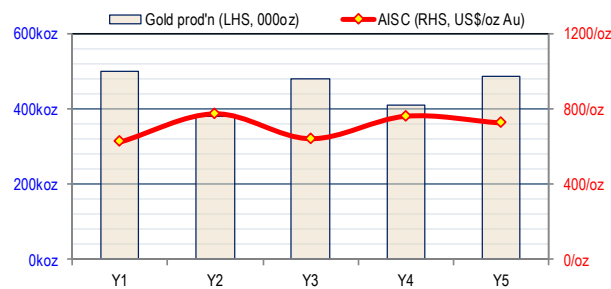
Gear company NAV diluted for mine build, net G&A and finance costs

1xNAV FF FD (C\$/sh)^	\$1800oz	\$1900oz	\$2000oz	\$2100oz	\$2200oz
10.0% discount	2,406	2,675	2,944	3,213	3,482
7.5% discount	2,519	2,806	3,093	3,380	3,668
5.0% discount	2,641	2,949	3,258	3,566	3,875
Gear project IRR:	40%	44%	47%	50%	53%
1xNAV FF FD (C\$/sh)^	\$1800oz	\$1900oz	\$2000oz	\$2100oz	\$2200oz
10.0% discount	19.65	22.28	24.93	27.59	30.25
7.5% discount	21.10	23.93	26.77	29.61	32.46
5.0% discount	22.65	25.69	28.7	31.80	34.86

*Project NPV incl grp SG&A & fin. cost, +net cash; *diluted for mine build equity

Production	Y1	Y2	Y3	Y4	Y5
Gold production (000oz)	500	380	480	410	485
C1 cost (US\$/oz)	541	661	555	634	623
AISC cost (US\$/oz)	626	772	643	759	724

AISC = C1 + ug sustaining capex, Y1 = 12M to Mar 2027



Source: SCP estimates

Resources	AuEq (koz)	AuEq (g/t)
Pitiable resource	5631koz	3.46g/t
Underground resource	393koz	5.86g/t
Snip	937koz	9.00g/t

Funding: uses		Funding: sources	
Build Capex	C\$713m	Cash + pre Au ITM options	C\$169m
SCPe G&A to 1st Au + NSR buyback	C\$53m	Franco convert	C\$0m
SCPe pre-production expl'n	C\$52m	Orion Debt	C\$467m
SCPe finance costs + wkg cap to Y1	C\$200m	Orion Stream	C\$267m
Total uses	C\$1019m	Orion Over-run	C\$131m
		Build Equity	C\$125m

*Cash from options expiring pre first pour

Ratio analysis	CY22A	CY23A	CY24E	CY25E	CY26E
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Average shares out (m)	71.5	84.7	100.1	106.3	109.6
EPS (C\$/sh)	-	-	-	-	-
CFPS (C\$/sh)	-	-	-	-	-
EV (C\$m)	441.6	505.8	510.2	731.1	1,055.7
FCF yield (%)	-	-	-	-	-
PER (x)	-	-	-	-	-
P/CF (x)	-	-	-	-	-
EV/EBITDA (x)	-	-	-	-	-

Income statement

	CY22A	CY23A	CY24E	CY25E	CY26E
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Net revenue (C\$m)

	-	-	-	-	-
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Gross profit (C\$m)

	-	-	-	-	-
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D&A, attrib (C\$m)

	0.3	0.4	0.2	-	-
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Admin (C\$m)

	21.2	24.0	21.7	17.8	17.8
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Expensed exploration (C\$m)

	91.6	91.9	55.0	14.0	3.0
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Finance cost (C\$m)

	(0.4)	(2.0)	0.3	17.0	60.9
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Royalty (C\$m)

	(9.5)	-	-	-	-
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Forex, other (C\$m)

	(14.3)	(4.5)	(0.2)	-	-
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Taxes (C\$m)

	-	(0.6)	-	-	-
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Net income (C\$m)

	(88.9)	(109.0)	(77.0)	(48.8)	(81.7)
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Cash flow, attrib.

	CY22A	CY23A	CY24E	CY25E	CY26E
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EBIT (C\$m)

	(89.3)	(111.7)	(76.8)	(31.8)	(20.8)
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Add back D&A (C\$m)

	0.3	0.4	0.2	-	-
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Less tax + net interest (C\$m)

	(0.4)	(2.7)	0.3	17.0	60.9
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Net change in wkg cap (C\$m)

	6.2	8.4	(2.1)	-	-
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Add back other non-cash (C\$m)

	(3.1)	8.0	4.2	-	-
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Cash flow ops (C\$m)

	(85.5)	(92.2)	(74.7)	(48.8)	(81.7)
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PP&E - build + sust (C\$m)

	11.8	31.3	(79.7)	(285.2)	(285.2)
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PP&E - expl'n (C\$m)

	(0.4)	-	22.5	-	-
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Cash flow inv. (C\$m)

	11.4	31.3	(57.2)	(285.2)	(285.2)
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Share issue (C\$m)

	82.7	110.9	100.0	25.0	-
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Proceeds from sale (C\$m)

	-	-	133.3	133.3	65.3
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Debt draw (repay) (C\$m)

	(0.5)	(1.0)	(0.4)	350.0	116.7
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Cash flow fin. (C\$m)

	82.3	109.9	232.9	508.3	182.0
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Net change in cash (C\$m)

	8.1	48.9	100.9	174.4	(184.9)
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EBITDA (C\$m)

	(89.0)	(111.3)	(79.8)	(36.0)	(21.9)
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Balance sheet

	CY22A	CY23A	CY24E	CY25E	CY26E
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Cash (C\$m)

	40.6	91.1	190.7	360.8	174.8
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Acc rec., inv., prepaid (C\$m)

	9.5	6.4	5.1	5.1	5.1
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PP&E + other (C\$m)

	117.9	97.5	152.2	437.4	722.6
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Total assets (C\$m)

	168.0	195.0	348.0	803.3	902.5
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Debt (C\$m)

	6.1	33.1	34.1	384.1	500.8
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Accounts payable (C\$m)

	14.0	20.6	16.2	16.2	16.2
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Others (C\$m)

	10.7	16.8	15.8	15.8	15.8
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Total liabilities (C\$m)

	30.8	70.5	66.1	416.1	532.8
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Sh'hlds equity + wrnts (C\$m)

	465.3	553.1	786.2	944.5	1,009.9
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Retained earn'gs + rsvs (C\$m)

	(328.1)	(428.6)	(505.1)	(558.1)	(640.9)
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Liabilities + equity (C\$m)

	168.0	195.0	347.2	802.6	901.7
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Summary of Recommendations as of June 2024	
BUY:	48
HOLD:	0
SELL:	0
UNDER REVIEW:	0
TENDER:	3
NOT RATED:	0
TOTAL	51

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